

Course Information

Course Title: Design Across Campus

Course Number: 104

Term: Spring 2023

Course Times: Online, Tuesdays 2-4:45 pm (Zoom link in the modules)

Professor: Dr. Katie Shilton

Pronouns: She/hers

Email: kshilton@umd.edu

Office Hours: Tuesdays, 2-4:45

Course Description

What is design, who does it, and how is it done? *There is no one answer to this question--it depends on who you ask.* The answers to these questions vary across disciplines and across the University campus. This course, designed with modules from contributors in UMD programs including Information Studies, Human-Computer Interaction, Graphic Design, Immersive Media Arts, Journalism, Architecture, Landscape Architecture, Engineering, and Policy, will introduce students to the goals and values, approaches, skills, and practices of diverse fields of design. It will enable students to identify grand challenges in design and serve as a *sorting hat* to help students find a design practice that matches their own values, approaches, skills and goals.

Learning Outcomes

After successfully completing this course you will be able to:

- Engage the questions of what design is, who does it, and how.
- Reveal the complexity of what design is, who does it, and how.
- Represent how diverse disciplinary contexts impact what design is, who does it, and how.
- Find opportunities for design within diverse disciplines.
- Identify grand challenges in diverse design disciplines.

- Create effective written and oral presentations.

Required Resources

- Norman, D. (2013). *The Design of Everyday Things: Revised and Expanded Edition* (Revised edition). Basic Books. ISBN 978-0-465-05065-9.
- Costanza-Chock, S. (2020). *Design Justice: Community-Led Practices to Build the Worlds We Need*. The MIT Press. ISBN 978-0-262-04345-8.
- The Libraries purchase textbooks for the largest courses on campus, including this one! They are available at the McKeldin Library Services Desk, and you can borrow them for 4 hours at a time. Find out more at go.umd.edu/textbooks [Links to an external site.](#) [Note: additional items may be on reserve and accessible in ELMS]

Course Structure

This is a **hybrid online** course. “Hybrid” means that it largely uses a “flipped classroom format” with optional meetings focused on questions and group activities. Lectures, readings, and solo activities are all provided online to complete on your own. The course will consist of online modules, frequent field trips and activities to complete at your own pace, and zoom meetings for group work and questions.

Tips for Success in an Online Course

1. **Participate.** Discussions and group work are a critical part of the course. You can learn a great deal from discussing ideas and perspectives with your peers and professor. Participation can also help you articulate your thoughts and develop critical thinking skills.
2. **Manage your time.** Make time for your online learning and participation in discussions each week. Give yourself plenty of time to complete assignments

- including extra time to handle any technology related problems.
3. **Login regularly.** Log in to ELMS-Canvas several times a week to view announcements, discussion posts and replies to your posts. You may need to log in multiple times a day when group submissions are due.
 4. **Do not fall behind.** This class moves at a quick pace and each week builds on the previous. It will be hard to keep up with the course content if you fall behind in the pre-work or post-work.
 5. **Use ELMS-Canvas notification settings.** Canvas ELMS-Canvas can ensure you receive timely notifications in your email or via text. Be sure to enable announcements to be sent instantly or daily.
 6. **Ask for help if needed.** If you need help with ELMS-Canvas or other technology, IT Support. If you are struggling with a course concept, reach out to me, and your classmates, for support.

UMD Policies and Resources for Undergraduate Courses

It is our shared responsibility to know and abide by the University of Maryland's policies that relate to all courses, which include topics like:

- Academic integrity
- Student and instructor conduct
- Accessibility and accommodations
- Attendance and excused absences
- Grades and appeals
- Copyright and intellectual property

Please visit www.ugst.umd.edu/courserelatedpolicies.html [Links to an external site.](#) for the Office of Undergraduate Studies' full list of campus-wide policies and follow up with me if you have questions.

Names/Pronouns and Self-Identifications

The University of Maryland recognizes the importance of a diverse student body, and we are committed to fostering inclusive and equitable classroom environments. I invite you, if you wish, to tell us how you want to be referred to both in terms of your name and your pronouns (he/him, she/her, they/them, etc.). The pronouns someone indicates are not necessarily indicative of their gender identity. Visit trans.umd.edu [Links to an external site.](#) to learn more.

Additionally, how you identify in terms of your gender, race, class, sexuality, religion, and dis/ability, among all aspects of your identity, is your choice whether to disclose (e.g., should it come up in classroom conversation about our experiences and perspectives) and should be self-identified, not presumed or imposed. I will do my best to address and refer to all students accordingly, and I ask you to do the same for all of your fellow Terps.

Communication with Instructor:

Email: If you need to reach out and communicate with me, please email me at kshilton@umd.edu. Please DO NOT email me with questions that are easily found in the syllabus or on ELMS (i.e. When is this assignment due? How much is it worth? etc.) but please DO reach out about personal, academic, and intellectual concerns/questions.

While I will do my best to respond to emails within 24 hours, I do not respond to email on Saturdays and Sundays.

ELMS: I will send IMPORTANT announcements via ELMS messaging. You must make sure that your email & announcement notifications (including changes in assignments and/or due dates) are enabled in ELMS so you do not miss any messages. You are responsible for checking your email and Canvas/ELMS inbox with regular frequency.

Communication with Peers:

With a diversity of perspectives and experience, we may find ourselves in disagreement and/or debate with one another. As such, it is important that we agree to conduct ourselves in a professional manner and that we work together to foster and preserve a virtual classroom environment in which we can respectfully discuss and deliberate controversial questions.

I encourage you to confidently exercise your right to free speech—bearing in mind, of course, that you will be expected to craft and defend arguments that support your position. Keep in mind, that free speech has its limit and this course is NOT the space for hate speech, harassment, and derogatory language. I will make every reasonable attempt

to create an atmosphere in which each student feels comfortable voicing their argument without fear of being personally attacked, mocked, demeaned, or devalued.

Any behavior (including harassment, sexual harassment, and racially and/or culturally derogatory language) that threatens this atmosphere will not be tolerated. Please alert me immediately if you feel threatened, dismissed, or silenced at any point during our semester together and/or if your engagement in discussion has been in some way hindered by the learning environment.

Major Assignments

Homework Assignments

- Reading discussions and questions (can be completed in class with your group, or independently).
- Sorting hat worksheets
 - What are the values, approaches, skills and practices of each design area we cover?
 - How do you relate to the values, approaches, skills and practices of the module's design area?
 - What next steps would help you pursue this area of design?
- Activities
 - Periodic activities with small deliverables (a picture, etc) to be turned in or shared with classmates on discussion boards

Individual Projects

Sharing good design: What is a design that you particularly love? Make a video, art piece, or story about a piece of **information design, interaction or experience design**, or **infrastructure design** that you love. What makes it *good*?

But also go beyond what makes it good and do some research into *how* it was made. Who made it, and what disciplines were they trained in or drawing from (if any?) What practices did they use? What values does the design reflect? Whose perspectives were included, and whose were left out?

You will share your video/art piece/stories on our course site and receive feedback from your peers.

Individual projects will be graded according to the following rubric:

Engages the questions of what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Presentation displays insightful answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Satisfactory: Presentation answers what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation provides only minimal answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Poor: Presentation does not provide answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.
Reveal the complexity of what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Presentation is insightful about the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the chosen design.	Satisfactory: Presentation acknowledges the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the chosen design.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation provides only minimal discussion of the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shape design.	Poor: Presentation does not discuss the political, social, economic and/or ethical dimensions that shape design.
Represent how diverse disciplinary contexts impact what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Presentation displays insightful reflection on how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Satisfactory: Presentation discusses how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Unsatisfactory: Homework misses important aspects of how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Poor: Homework does not reflect on how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.
Makes a persuasive argument	Excellent: Presentation makes a convincing argument for the success of a design using	Satisfactory: Presentation makes a solid argument for the success of a	Unsatisfactory: Presentation makes an argument for the success of a design but lacks	Poor: Presentation fails to make a convincing argument for the success of a design and lacks

	appropriate evidence.	design using evidence.	appropriate evidence.	appropriate evidence.
Introduces own ideas	Excellent: Presentation synthesizes personal viewpoints or experiences with analysis of the chosen design.	Satisfactory: Presentation includes some personal viewpoints or experiences.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation includes few personal viewpoints or experiences.	Poor: Presentation does not include personal viewpoints or experiences.
Clearly communicates ideas	Excellent: Presentation uses creative organization and compelling narration to engage viewers.	Satisfactory: Presentation uses logical organization and clear narration to engage viewers.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation lacks clear organization, or narration is unclear and difficult to follow.	Poor: Presentation lacks clear organization and narration is unclear and difficult to follow.

Poster Project

You will make a poster using UX design principles to advertise the item your partner picked for their "good design" presentation. Watch your partner's video, interview them during class time about the design they loved, and create an informative, visually-appealing poster about the item they have chosen. They are your client, and should give you feedback on your poster before you turn it in.

Poster projects will be graded according to the following rubric:

Engages the questions of what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Displays insightful answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Satisfactory: Answers what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Unsatisfactory: Provides only minimal answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Poor: Does not provide answers to questions of what a chosen design represents, who contributed
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				to it, and how.
Reveal the complexity of what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Insightful about the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the chosen design.	Satisfactory: Acknowledges the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the chosen design.	Unsatisfactory: Provides only minimal discussion of the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shape design.	Poor: Does not discuss the political, social, economic and/or ethical dimensions that shape design.
Represent how diverse disciplinary contexts impact what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Displays insightful reflection on how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Satisfactory: Discusses how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Unsatisfactory: Misses important aspects of how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.	Poor: Does not reflect on how the disciplinary context impacts what a chosen design represents, who contributed to it, and how.
Makes a persuasive argument	Excellent: Makes a convincing argument for the success of a design using appropriate evidence.	Satisfactory: Makes a solid argument for the success of a design using evidence.	Unsatisfactory: Makes an argument for the success of a design but lacks appropriate evidence.	Poor: Fails to make a convincing argument for the success of a design and lacks appropriate evidence.
Introduces own ideas	Excellent: Synthesizes personal viewpoints or experiences with	Satisfactory: Includes some personal viewpoints or experiences.	Unsatisfactory: Includes few personal	Poor: Does not include personal

	analysis of the chosen design.		viewpoints or experiences.	viewpoints or experiences.
Clearly communicates ideas	Excellent: Uses creative organization and compelling text and images to engage viewers.	Satisfactory: Uses logical organization and clear text and images to engage viewers.	Unsatisfactory: Lacks clear organization, or text is unclear and difficult to follow.	Poor: No organizational scheme makes the poster ineffective.

Final Project

With your team, identify 2-3 **grand challenges** in a specific design area. Grand challenges are difficult problems that a group of people – a profession, an institution – believe are critically important to solve. Create a presentation that explains what the grand challenges are, how you identified these challenges (your sources), and why the challenges are important. Identify who might work on those problems in the future, and what resources it would take.

Final projects will be graded according to the following rubric:

Identify grand challenges in particular design disciplines.	Excellent: Presentation identifies multiple grand challenges in the relevant design discipline.	Satisfactory: Presentation identifies a grand challenge in the relevant design discipline.	Unsatisfactory: Challenges identified do not rise to the level of grand challenges.	Poor: Presentation does not identify challenges in the relevant design discipline.
Reveal the complexity of what design is, who does it, and how.	Excellent: Presentation is insightful about the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the grand challenges identified.	Satisfactory: Presentation acknowledges the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the grand challenges identified.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation provides only minimal discussion of the political, social, economic, and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the grand challenges identified.	Poor: Presentation does not discuss the political, social, economic and/or ethical dimensions that shaped the grand challenges identified.
Find opportunities for	Excellent: Presentation is	Satisfactory: Presentation	Unsatisfactory: Presentation has	Poor: Presentation does not reflect

design within diverse disciplines	insightful about opportunities for design within the topic discipline.	reflects on opportunities for design within the topic discipline.	minimal reflection on opportunities for design within the topic discipline.	on opportunities for design within the topic discipline.
Introduces own ideas	Excellent: Presentation synthesizes personal viewpoints or experiences with the grand challenges identified.	Satisfactory: Presentation includes some personal viewpoints or experiences.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation includes few personal viewpoints or experiences.	Poor: Presentation does not include personal viewpoints or experiences.
Makes a persuasive argument	Excellent: Presentation makes a convincing argument that the challenges presented meet the requirements of grand challenges.	Satisfactory: Presentation makes a solid argument that the challenges presented meet the requirements of grand challenges.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation makes an argument that the challenges presented meet the requirements of grand challenges but lacks appropriate evidence.	Poor: Presentation fails to make a convincing argument that the challenges presented meet the requirements of grand challenges and lacks appropriate evidence.
Clearly communicates ideas	Excellent: Presentation uses creative organization and compelling narration to engage viewers.	Satisfactory: Presentation uses logical organization and clear narration to engage viewers.	Unsatisfactory: Presentation lacks clear organization, or narration is unclear and difficult to follow.	Poor: Presentation lacks clear organization and narration is unclear and difficult to follow.
Works successfully as a team	Excellent: The final project made optimal use of each team member's skills and interests.	Satisfactory: Each team member contributed equitably to the final project.	Unsatisfactory: Team members had difficulty engaging this student in the project.	Poor: This student did not contribute to the final project.

Grading Structure

Assignment	Percentage %
Sorting hat worksheets	20%
Reading reflections and activities	20%
Individual Project (Sharing Good Design)	20%
Poster Project	20%
Group Final Project (Grand Challenges)	20%
Total	100%

Late Work Policy

Meeting class deadlines is typically one of the biggest challenges that students face. On one hand, meeting deadlines is important in the working world, and is good to practice now. Meeting deadlines also makes grading infinitely easier for the instructor and TAs. On the other hand, even in the working world, there is often flexibility around deadlines. And many of you have other commitments ranging from work to family that may make your classwork difficult to finish on time. Throw a pandemic into the mix and deadlines will likely be the #1 issue for many of you.

As a result, this class has a *flexible deadline policy*. **You can ask in advance for an extension on any assignment you need, no questions asked or excuses needed. But you must ask your TA in advance of the due date**, and you must tell your TA the new date by which you plan to have the assignment in, so that they can plan for grading. You can find out which TA you have been assigned to under the [People](#) tab in the ELMS menu (look for "TA Groups").

If you do not contact your TA for an extension in advance, you will only receive partial credit for any late work. This will be half credit for small assignments like worksheets, reading reflections, and activities. For major assignments such as your individual, poster, and grand challenge presentations, you will lose half a letter grade per day the assignment is late. (E.g. one day late, an A presentation will automatically be an A-).

Academic Integrity for Design Across Campus

Design is fundamentally an exercise in creativity. Therefore, creativity will be the most important value in the course. Design also requires acknowledging your inspirations. I expect that you will be inspired by the work of others, and that you will credit this work.

The University's [Code of Academic Integrity](#) [Links to an external site.](#) is designed to ensure that the principles of academic honesty and integrity are upheld. In accordance with this code, the iSchool does not tolerate academic dishonesty. Please ensure that you fully understand this code and its implications because all acts of academic dishonesty will be dealt with in accordance with the provisions of this code. All students are expected to adhere to this Code. It is your responsibility to read it and know what it says, so you can start your academic life on the right path.

It is important to note that course assistance websites, such as CourseHero, are not permitted sources, unless the instructor explicitly gives permission for you to use one of these sites. Material taken or copied from these sites can be deemed unauthorized material and a violation of academic integrity. These sites offer information that might not be accurate and that shortcut the learning process, particularly the critical thinking steps necessary for college-level assignments.

Additionally, it is understandable that students may use a variety of online or virtual forums for course-wide discussion (e.g., GroupME or WeChat). Collaboration in this way regarding concepts discussed in this course is permissible. However, collaboration on graded assignments is strictly prohibited unless otherwise stated. Examples of prohibited collaboration include: asking classmates for answers on quizzes or exams, asking for access codes to clicker polls, etc.

Finally, on each assignment you must write out and sign the following pledge:

"I pledge on my honor that I have not given or received any unauthorized assistance on this exam/assignment."

Please visit the [Office of Undergraduate Studies' full list of campus-wide policies](#) [Links to an external site.](#) and follow up with me if you have questions.

Grades

All assessment scores will be posted on the course ELMS page. If you would like to review any of your grades or have questions about how something was scored, please email me to schedule a time for us to meet and discuss.

Final letter grades are assigned based on the percentage of total assessment points earned. To be fair to everyone I have to establish clear standards and apply them consistently, so please understand that being close to a cutoff is not the same as making the cut (89.99 $\neq$ 90.00). It would be unethical to make exceptions for some and not others.

Final Grade Cutoffs

+	97.00%	+	87.00%	+	77.00%	+	67.00%	+	
A	94.00%	B	84.00%	C	74.00%	D	64.00%	F	<60.0%
-	90.00%	-	80.00%	-	70.00%	-	60.00%	-	

Notice of Mandatory Reporting

Notice of mandatory reporting of sexual assault, sexual harassment, interpersonal violence, and stalking: As a faculty member, I am designated as a “Responsible University Employee,” and I must report all disclosures of sexual assault, sexual harassment, interpersonal violence, and stalking to UMD’s Title IX Coordinator per University Policy on Sexual Harassment and Other Sexual Misconduct.

If you wish to speak with someone confidentially, please contact one of UMD’s confidential resources, such as [CARE to Stop Violence Links to an external site.](#) (located on the Ground Floor of the Health Center) at 301-741-3442 or the [Counseling CenterLinks to an external site.](#) (located at the Shoemaker Building) at 301-314-7651.

You may also seek assistance or supportive measures from UMD’s Title IX Coordinator, Angela Nastase, by calling 301-405-1142, or emailing titleIXcoordinator@umd.edu.

To view further information on the above, please visit the [Office of Civil Rights and Sexual Misconduct's Links to an external site.](#) website at ocrsm.umd.eduLinks to an external site.

Basic Needs Security

If you have difficulty affording groceries or accessing sufficient food to eat every day, or lack a safe and stable place to live, please visit [UMD’s Division of Student Affairs websiteLinks to an external site.](#) for information about resources the campus offers you and let me know if I can help in any way.

Veteran Resources

UMD provides some additional supports to our student veterans. You can access those resources at the office of [Veteran Student lifeLinks to an external site.](#) and

the [Counseling CenterLinks to an external site.](#). Veterans and active duty military personnel with special circumstances (e.g., upcoming deployments, drill requirements, disabilities) are welcome and encouraged to communicate these, in advance if possible, to the instructor.

Course Summary:

Date	Details
Tue Jan 31, 2023	Calendar Event First zoom session
	Discussion Topic Week 1 Activity: Meet your Classmates
Mon Feb 6, 2023	Discussion Topic Week 1 Activity: Norman Doors
	Quiz Week 1: Syllabus Quiz
	Assignment Week 2 Activity: Embodied Prototyping (Option: In class)
Mon Feb 13, 2023	Discussion Topic Week 2 Activity: Field Trip and Reflection
	Discussion Topic Week 2 Activity: Values Mapping
	Discussion Topic Week 3 Activity: Blind Contour Drawing (Option: In Class)
	Assignment Week 3 Activity: Learning How You Learn
Mon Feb 20, 2023	Discussion Topic Week 3 Activity: Slow Looking
	Assignment Week 3: Reflection
	Discussion Topic Week 4 Activity: Achieving Flow
Mon Feb 27, 2023	Assignment Week 4 Activity: Protobot (Option: In Class)
Mon Mar 6, 2023	Discussion Topic Sharing Good Design

Date	Details
	Assignment Sharing Good Design
	Discussion Topic Week 5 Activity: Brainspin: Let's Compare Answers
	Assignment Week 5 Activity: Let's Play Brainspin!
	Assignment Week 5: Reflection (Option: In Class)
	Assignment Policy and design sorting hat worksheet
Mon Mar 13, 2023	Assignment Journalism and design sorting hat worksheet
	Assignment Reflection on Good Design videos (Option: In class)
	Assignment AI & Design sorting hat worksheet
Mon Mar 20, 2023	Assignment Information, design and technology sorting hat worksheet
	Discussion Topic Week 7: Information, design and technology activity: Build a Bot
	Quiz Week 7: Reading Reflection (Option: In class)
	Assignment Immersive media design sorting hat worksheet
Mon Apr 3, 2023	Quiz Week 9: Checking in
	Quiz Week 9: Reading Reflection (Option: In class)
	Assignment Graphic design sorting hat worksheet
Mon Apr 10, 2023	Assignment Theater and performance studies sorting hat worksheet
	Discussion Topic Week 10: Graphic Design and Arts

Date	Details
	Discussion Topic Week 10: Visualizing Text & Analysis Activity
	Assignment Architecture sorting hat worksheet
Mon Apr 17, 2023	Assignment Critical engineering design sorting hat worksheet
	Discussion Topic Week 11: Architecture Discussion
	Discussion Topic Week 11: Critical Engineering Design Activity
Mon Apr 24, 2023	Assignment Evaluating a CAD Tool (Option: In class)
	Assignment Poster Project
	Assignment Give the gift of feedback
Mon May 1, 2023	Quiz Week 13: Reading Reflection (Option: In Class)
	Assignment Week 13: Reflection
Mon May 8, 2023	Assignment Week 14: Reflection
Fri May 12, 2023	Assignment Final Project - Grand Challenges
Mon May 15, 2023	Assignment Teamwork assessment
	Discussion Topic Week 15 Activity: Debrief - I Like, I Wish

Assignments are weighted by group:

Group	Weight
Activities and reflections	20%
Projects	60%
Sorting Hat Worksheets	20%
Total	100%